

JESUS PENA JR.

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EDUCATION

University of Texas Rio Grande Valley (UTRGV)

Bachelor of Business Administration in Management, Minor in Legal Studies; GPA: 3.3

- **Honors & Affiliations:** Beta Gamma Sigma (Top 10%), Association of Latino Professionals for America, Tau Kappa Epsilon Fraternity

South Texas College (STC)

Associate of Arts in Interdisciplinary Studies, Concentration in Political Science; GPA: 3.4

- **Honors:** Earned concurrently with high school, Vice President's List (2025)

Edinburg, TX

Expected May 2028

McAllen, TX

Aug. 2023 - May 2025

CORE COMPETENCIES & INTERESTS

Strategy & Operations: Project Management, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Stakeholder Engagement, Budget Oversight

Research & Decision Support: Market Research, Competitive Benchmarking, Data Analysis, KPI Tracking

Communications & Brand Management: Brand Messaging, Content Strategy, Social Media Analytics, Public Relations

Tools: Hootsuite, Canva, MS Office Suite, Generative AI Tools (Copilot)

Personal Interests: Pickleball, Thrifting, and Cinema

WORK EXPERIENCE

JDG Jewelers | Mission Ready Program

Mission, TX

Business Strategy & Growth Intern

Jun. 2026 - Present

- Audited 116 Meta ads and identified that 92% of an \$8,000+ advertising budget (~\$7,400) was allocated to engagement-objective campaigns producing likes and clicks with no measurable sales; built a reallocation plan to redirect spend toward conversion-driven revenue.
- Benchmarked 4 regional competitors and analyzed 500+ customer reviews to map gaps in pricing, digital presence, and after-sale experience; developed differentiation recommendations centered on customer experience and brand trust.
- Designed and led a bilingual (English/Spanish) end-of-summer marketing campaign, including a custom tiered promotional structure, channel strategy, and print collateral, to reposition brand messaging from a discount-first approach to a premium, trust-first brand positioning.

Texas Department of Transportation (TxDOT) | District Headquarters

Pharr, TX

Public Information Officer (PIO) Intern

Mar. 2026 - Present

- Manage official government communications across Facebook, Instagram, and X via Hootsuite CMS, tracking performance across 6 campaigns to deliver timely public information and build public trust with residents across 8 South Texas counties.
- Produced and published 28+ videos for the district's Facebook page generating 1.2M+ views and 54,600+ engagements.
- Expanded agency reach to 420,958 unique viewers, 83% of them non-followers, driving 1,200+ new Facebook followers and more than doubling Instagram audience (200 to 529+) at zero paid media spend.
- **Project: District Social Media Audit (Self-Initiated)**
 - Conceptualized and executed a KPI audit of 172 posts and 592K+ impressions benchmarked against national DOT communication standards; delivered a formal report and presentation with content-mix and cadence recommendations adopted by district PIO leadership at zero additional headcount or cost.

ORGANIZATIONAL LEADERSHIP

UTRGV Student Government Association (SGA)

Edinburg, TX

Financial Affairs Committee Chairman | Edinburg Senator At-Large | College of Business Senator (#1 Vote Getter)

Aug. 2025 - Present

- Unanimously elected by the Senate to chair the committee governing the audit, compliance, and allocation of an \$80,000 annual budget for student organizations and special event funds.
- Elected Senator At-Large by 394+ students, the highest vote total campus-wide, representing 30,000+ students; previously represented 4,000+ students across 8 departments as College of Business Senator.
- Progressed from First-Year Intern to appointed Senator and elected Senator At-Large within one academic year.

Future Business Leaders of America (FBLA) – National, State & UTRGV Chapter

Reston, VA | Edinburg, TX

National Collegiate Vice President of Communications

Jun. 2026 - Present

Texas Executive Vice President

Jul. 2026 - Present

Co-Founder & EVP, UTRGV Chapter

Jan. 2026 - Present

- Elected to national executive office and concurrently selected by state leadership as Texas EVP, representing 500+ chapters and 10,000+ members; set organization-wide communications and branding standards.
- Directed end-to-end development of a full-stack chapter management platform (utrgvfbla.com) serving 50+ members, membership applications, QR-based event check-in, an automated points/leaderboard system, and officer administration.
- Co-founded UTRGV's FBLA chapter, recruiting an 8-person leadership team and advancing the chapter to Nationals in its inaugural year.
- Direct multi-channel communications strategy with the National Officer Team, drafting the 2026–2027 Program of Work and overseeing the national Social Media Ambassadors program across social, email, and event channels, while promoting relevant content to collegiate division

Enactus RGV

Edinburg, TX

Executive Board Member | Public Relations | Project Manager, Micro-Internship Initiative

May 2025 - May 2026

- Directed communications strategy and community operations for a multi-city initiative serving 1,000+ families by coordinating volunteers, logistics, and site management across 2 locations.
- Conducted 13 one-on-one business consultations and standardized 16 internship role descriptions, creating a repeatable placement framework adopted across the initiative; personally placed with Joe's Auto Repair & Sales LLC, where I led market research and customer segmentation analysis and delivered 3 data-informed brand strategy options with a stakeholder-ready implementation roadmap.

AWARDS

FBLA State Management Case Competition, 2nd Place (2026); Enactus USA National Finalist (2026); BPA National Small Business Management Case Competition, 4th Place (2025); Enactus Rookie of the Year (2026); Texas BPA State Man of the Year (2024, 2025); Valley Automobile Dealers Association Scholarship (2025, 2026); Robert C. Vackar Endowed Scholarship for Aspiring Entrepreneurs (2025)